PHILEMON

Conversational Version

Salutation

[1]Paul, prisoner of Christ[Messiah] Jesus, and brother Timothy, to our dear fellow worker Philemon, [2]to sister Apphia, to fellow soldier Archippus, and to your[sg] house church. [3]Grace and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. **Phil 1-3**

Paul's Prayer for Philemon

[4]I always thank God *for you*, mentioning you[sg] in my prayers, [5]because I hear about your love and faith toward the Lord Jesus and all the saints. [6]I pray that fellowshiping with your[sg] faith will lead to our experiencing everything good for Christ's sake. [7]Brother, I'm so happy and encouraged by your love, because you refresh the hearts of the saints. **Phil 4-7**

Requesting Freedom for Onesimus

[8]In light of that, I feel bold enough to tell *you* something that's appropriate. [9]But because I love you, I'd rather ask you to do it—being Paul the aged prisoner of Christ, and all.

[10]I'm appealing to you about my child Onesimus that I begot while I was in bonds. [11]At one time he was useless to you, but now he's useful to you and to me. [12]As my own heart, I've sent him back to you in person. [13]I wanted to keep him here to help me on your behalf while I'm in prison because of the good news. [14]But I didn't want to do anything without your consent. I wanted your goodness to be because you wanted to, not because you had to. [15-16]Maybe he left you for a while so you could have him forever physically and in the Lord, not as a servant, but as a dear brother—to me too. **Phil 8-16**

Additional Urgings About Onesimus

[17]So if you consider me a partner, accept him as me. [18]If he has wronged you or owes you anything, charge it to me. [19]I, Paul, write it with my own hand: I'll repay it. (I won't tell you that you also owe me your very self.) [20]Yes, brother, I want to have joy in the Lord; refresh my heart in Christ. [21]I'm writing, confident that you'll do more than I'm saying. [22]While you're at it, prepare[sg] a place for me to stay, because I'm hoping by your[pl] prayers to be released to you[pl]. **Phil 17-22**

Greetings

[23]Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in Christ Jesus, sends you[sg] greetings. [24]Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, Luke—my fellow workers—*greet you as well*.

[25]The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ *be* with your[pl] spirit. **Phil 23-25**

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